

# Philipp Hilbert. *Payments Product Manager, retail-scale checkout.*

*Positioning*, Payments-domain PM with a fintech founding track and 13 years shipping regulated products end-to-end, now focused on GCC checkout and PSP performance.

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## § WHY LANDMARK DIGITAL

Landmark Digital is the rare case where payments complexity is genuinely earned: seven live brands, eight GCC markets, every local method from Mada to BNPL, and a checkout funnel that runs at retail scale. The combination of multi-brand product ownership and deep regional payment localisation is exactly the kind of environment where funnel-level thinking compounds quickly. The founding story of Kvitt Payment Solutions, a P2P product built inside the girocard ecosystem and acquired by Sparkasse, gave me a permanent allergy to treating PSP integrations as plumbing rather than product. *That hands-on payments DNA is what I would bring to the Centrepont and Max checkout funnels from day one.*

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## § HONEST FRAMING

Landmark's GCC-specific methods, Mada, regional 3DS2 flows, and Gulf-local BNPL rails, are payment rails I have read about rather than shipped on directly. My card-payments and PSP integration experience is solid; the GCC localisation layer is a ramp I would complete in the first weeks by spending time with the regional teams and existing payment partners rather than learning it abstractly.

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## § AI-NATIVE STACK

*Daily tools, not buzzwords.*

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and edge-case generation
- **Cursor / VSCode**, SQL and requirements drafting
- **GitHub Copilot**, acceptance criteria and test scaffolding
- **Lovable**, rapid checkout flow prototyping
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-facing roadmap decks
- **Figma**, wireframes and UAT annotation
- **GPT**, funnel analysis drafts and partner briefing documents
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation

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## § TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

*Shipped with, not just listed.*

Jira, Confluence, Azure DevOps, Figma, Miro for product delivery; PostgreSQL and SQL for funnel and payment analysis; REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, MongoDB, Kafka for integration work; Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins for platform environments; Dagster, dbt for ETL and data-pipeline product ownership; Matomo and MicroStrategy for analytics.

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## § SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

*Two-sided B2B construction-staffing marketplace, built zero-to-one as a solo founder.*

- Anonymity-until-payment model protects both sides until commitment, keeping the funnel clean and fraud risk low.
- WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, removing app-install friction entirely.
- LLM agents across the funnel so one person runs the full day-to-day operation.
- Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL, the same instrumentation discipline this payments role requires.

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## § HOW I WOULD WORK AT LANDMARK DIGITAL

*First weeks, concrete.*

### WEEK 1

#### **Listen, map, find the gaps.**

Shadow payment operations, pull Payment Success Rate dashboards, map the existing gateway routing logic across all seven brands, and build a shared picture of where the funnel leaks most.

### WEEK 2

#### **Slice, prioritise, validate.**

Pick the single highest-impact failure pattern from the data, write clear user stories and acceptance criteria, and validate the root-cause hypothesis with engineering and the relevant PSP before writing a line of spec.

### WEEK 3+

#### **Ship, close loops.**

Drive the first initiative through UAT and production release, set up recurring PSR reporting cadence, and start shaping the broader roadmap input for the Senior Product Owner.

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## **I** COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team at Landmark Digital,

I am applying for the Payments Product Manager role. My interest is specific: Kvitt Payment Solutions, which I co-founded in 2013, was a mobile P2P group-payments product built from zero and taken all the way to acquisition by Sparkasse, operating inside the girocard ecosystem. That experience gave me a hands-on understanding of PSP integration, payment flows, dispute handling, and the edge cases that only surface once real money is moving at volume. Landmark Digital's challenge, running a coherent payment experience across seven brands and multiple GCC markets, is a complexity I find genuinely compelling rather than daunting.

At Scheidt & Bachmann Fuel & Convenience Retail, I was Product Owner on an integration team covering POS and forecourt payment systems in a fully SAFe organisation. I coordinated partner integrations, managed dependencies across agile release trains, and moved research results into production across a matrix organisation, the same cross-functional discipline the Landmark payments role requires when coordinating with PSPs, acquirers, and internal brand teams simultaneously. At EMIL Group I restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into

three focused teams and shipped the Claims Center from concept to production: that is the kind of end-to-end ownership, from problem definition through UAT and release, that the posting describes as the core of this role.

On the analytical side, I use SQL directly to investigate funnel behaviour, at construct8 I instrumented the conversion funnel myself and made prioritisation decisions on that data rather than waiting for a dashboard to be built for me. Payment Success Rate analysis, decline pattern investigation, and gateway performance comparison are exactly the problem-solving motions I default to. I bring the same instrumentation discipline from my work on the FCAS AI and data platform at Rohde & Schwarz, where I redirected the entire product strategy based on instrumenting two competing workflows and reading the data.

I am aware that my direct GCC payments experience is limited: I know the card and PSP mechanics well, but the regional specifics of Mada, Gulf-local BNPL providers, and GCC 3DS2 flows are a ramp rather than an established strength. I call this out because I think it is more useful than papering over it. The underlying mechanics are the same, and my track record of getting up to speed quickly in new payment and regulatory contexts, from girocard at Kvitt to PCI-adjacent POS systems at Scheidt & Bachmann, gives me confidence I would close that gap in the first weeks through time with the existing team and payment partners.

Landmark Digital's position as the digital engine behind a portfolio of established retail brands at real GCC scale is exactly the kind of environment where payment product ownership has visible, measurable stakes. I would welcome the chance to talk through how my background fits the specific needs of the Centrepont and Max checkout funnels.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

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## II CURRICULUM VITAE

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### § BEARING

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries, with a payments founding track that runs from zero-to-acquisition at Kvitt Payment Solutions through POS and forecourt payment integration at Scheidt & Bachmann. I run continuous discovery, translate business and compliance constraints into prioritised backlogs, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery from problem definition through UAT and release. The career thread across fintech, insurance, public-sector data, and defence AI is always the same: own the full value chain, instrument what matters, and make data-backed decisions at every gate.

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## § WHAT I CAN DO

**Payments and E-commerce:** P2P payment product design, PSP and gateway integration, girocard ecosystem, POS and forecourt payments, dispute and reconciliation workflows, Shopware webshop, checkout funnel analysis, payment success rate optimisation

**Product Ownership and Delivery:** user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, backlog refinement, sprint planning, UAT, release planning, Jira, Confluence, Azure DevOps, Figma, Miro

**Product Management:** continuous discovery, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research, go-to-market support, funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition

**Analytics and Data:** SQL, PostgreSQL, funnel analysis, ETL, Dagster, dbt, Matomo, MicroStrategy

**Agile and Scaled Delivery:** Scrum, Kanban, SAgile, agile release train, PI planning

**Technical Environments:** Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, MongoDB, Kafka, Git, GitLab

**AI Products and Tooling:** LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, EU AI Act, Explainable AI

**Governance:** GDPR, PCI-DSS awareness, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership

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## § PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

Owned roadmap and delivery for the FCAS AI and data platform; led 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum. Redirected strategy from UI-led to developer-code-first based on instrumented workflow data, lifting pipeline runs 200%; reduced rollout time from days to 30 minutes via GitOps with ArgoCD.

### BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

National labour-market analytics platform, Deputy IT Security Officer. Introduced Dagster and dbt, cutting data-update time by 75%; migrated bare-metal system to containers; delivered full UI relaunch and ETL migration in parallel.

#### CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM/KIS interface, reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

#### EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery organisation into three focused teams; attrition dropped from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut new-product launch time from months to under a week.

#### SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021-2022

POS and forecourt payment systems. Moved research results into production in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning across a matrix organisation.

#### BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER · GOVERNMENT SECURE DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

#### AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE E-COMMERCE 2019-2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

#### ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end across Wismar and Magdeburg sites.

#### WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

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#### § FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

#### CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING 2025-2026

Two-sided B2B marketplace, zero to one alone. Anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, conversion analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · IT SECURITY 2016-2021

Quantum-secure encryption, integrated hardware and software. Shipped three-layer product with sub-two-minute install time; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·  
NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018-2021

Laboratory to investor rounds: owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH 2013-2018

Mobile P2P group-based payments, built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse, operating inside the girocard ecosystem.

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## § LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · LANDMARK GROUP

